

# Parent Meal Prep Monotony — Action Checklist

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PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

## BUILD YOUR MEAL PREP SYSTEM

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- ☐ **Batch-cook the five foundation foods including meatballs, pancakes, roasted vegetables, sauces, and soups during a 2-3 hour Sunday session so your weekday meal prep drops from 45 minutes to just 10-15 minutes.:** Batch-cook the five foundation foods including meatballs, pancakes, roasted vegetables, sauces, and soups during a 2-3 hour Sunday session so your weekday meal prep drops from 45 minutes to just 10-15 minutes.
- ☐ **Follow the structured Sunday timeline by spending the first hour making meatballs and roasting vegetables, the second hour preparing a sauce or soup, and the final 30 minutes cooking and freezing pancakes in stacks.:** Follow the structured Sunday timeline by spending the first hour making meatballs and roasting vegetables, the second hour preparing a sauce or soup, and the final 30 minutes cooking and freezing pancakes in stacks.
- ☐ **Label every container with the preparation date before storing in the freezer since most batch-cooked foods remain good for 2-3 months when properly dated and frozen flat.:** Label every container with the preparation date before storing in the freezer since most batch-cooked foods remain good for 2-3 months when properly dated and frozen flat.
- ☐ **Select foods that actually freeze and reheat well such as meatballs that reheat in a skillet with sauce and pancakes that work perfectly in a toaster, rather than foods that become grey and sad when reheated.:** Select foods that actually freeze and reheat well such as meatballs that reheat in a skillet with sauce and pancakes that work perfectly in a toaster, rather than foods that become grey and sad when reheated.

## SET UP YOUR ROTATIONS

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- ☐ **Commit to the 4-week rotation schedule as-written for at least one full cycle rather than trying to customize it immediately, because four weeks provides enough variety while remaining manageable to actually follow through on.:** Commit to the 4-week rotation schedule as-written for at least one full cycle rather than trying to customize it immediately, because four weeks provides enough variety while remaining manageable to actually follow through on.

- **Use the provided breakfast rotation template to eliminate the daily what-are-we-eating question entirely, since the schedule already accounts for pancakes, yogurt, cereal, eggs, waffles, French toast, smoothies, and oatmeal throughout the week.:** Use the provided breakfast rotation template to eliminate the daily what-are-we-eating question entirely, since the schedule already accounts for pancakes, yogurt, cereal, eggs, waffles, French toast, smoothies, and oatmeal throughout the week.

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- **Implement the lunch rotation with its emphasis on quick assembly options like sandwiches, wraps, and pasta salads that can be thrown together in five minutes or less for kids who are rarely hungry for a full cooked meal at noon.:** Implement the lunch rotation with its emphasis on quick assembly options like sandwiches, wraps, and pasta salads that can be thrown together in five minutes or less for kids who are rarely hungry for a full cooked meal at noon.

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- **Follow the dinner rotation that includes all 15 kid-friendly meals, keeping in mind that the goal is meals the whole family can eat without making separate short order options for your children.:** Follow the dinner rotation that includes all 15 kid-friendly meals, keeping in mind that the goal is meals the whole family can eat without making separate short order options for your children.

## PREPARE FOR HARD DAYS

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- **Build a shelf-stable emergency stash with yogurt pouches, crackers and cheese, canned soup, frozen pizza, and quality boxed mac and cheese for the days when you forget to thaw something or your kid rejects everything.:** Build a shelf-stable emergency stash with yogurt pouches, crackers and cheese, canned soup, frozen pizza, and quality boxed mac and cheese for the days when you forget to thaw something or your kid rejects everything.

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  - **Keep the emergency stash completely separate from your regular meal plan and only use it for true emergencies rather than defaulting to it when you feel too tired to cook a planned meal.:** Keep the emergency stash completely separate from your regular meal plan and only use it for true emergencies rather than defaulting to it when you feel too tired to cook a planned meal.

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  - **Note when you use an emergency stash item so you can restock it before the next impossible day arrives, because an empty emergency stash defeats the purpose of having one at all.:** Note when you use an emergency stash item so you can restock it before the next impossible day arrives, because an empty emergency stash defeats the purpose of having one at all.
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- **Accept that some days will be impossible no matter how solid your system is, and having a ready-to-go stash means those days won't derail your entire meal plan for the week.:** Accept that some days will be impossible no matter how solid your system is, and having a ready-to-go stash means those days won't derail your entire meal plan for the week.

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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.